aversion to the West's imposition of its rules on the rest of the world.[31] It has been apprehensive about certain aspects of international financial governance, such as the imposition of conditionality on and interference in its domestic affairs, which challenge the principle of sovereignty, highly valued by the Chinese leadership. The Chinese government has been opposed to and suspicious of IMF surveillance and critical of IMF conditionality imposed on debtor nations during balance of payments crises.

Since the PRC joined the IMF in 1980, China has repeatedly indicated its discomfort with IMF conditionality. For example, not only did China resist full currency convertibility for sixteen years after joining the IMF, but it also made sure to avoid any balance-of-payments crisis that would call for IMF policy involvement.[32] In 2007 and 2008, furthermore, China suspended its Article IV consultation because it was unhappy with the way in which its foreign exchange rate policy was placed under scrutiny by the IMF as the country faced "currency manipulation" charges. During this period, the Chinese leadership underscored its frustration about IMF intrusion into "matters of national sovereignty."[33] Furthermore, as the Chinese government has quickly become one of the largest bilateral foreign aid donors, it has made clear its opposition to political conditionality attached to its own foreign aid, emphasizing its commitment to the principle of noninterference.[34]

Chinese leaders share the frustration over the underrepresentation of developing countries and unfairness of the way that adjustment pressures are placed on non-Western powers in the context of international financial imbalances, either as a deficit country (like Brazil) or a surplus country (like China).[35] Such frustration is also targeted at the exorbitant privilege of U.S. dollar dominance in the world, whereby U.S. macroeconomic or fiscal policy is hardly ever placed under IMF surveillance or financial discipline.

China strongly sympathizes with developing countries and emerging markets, which in its view "have been in [a] subordinate position [in the global financial system], constantly being governed and regulated by developed countries."[36] Recently, China found it almost intolerable to have to face obstruction by the United States (owing to Washington's dysfunctional politics rather than to opposition by President Barack Obama) blocking the agreed-upon 2010 IMF quota reform, and has been frustrated by delays in having the RMB included in Special Drawing Rights (SDRs).